told me he had been thus confined eight years; another, four years. The rest were chained two and two together, and those that went out had a long chain between them, which was taken off as soon as they returned into the arsenal. Their allowance from Government was one pound of biscuit a day, and some rice, and half a pound of meat three times a week.[1] They were employed in carrying water to this prison, the infirmary, and the great prison; and guarded by the military.

EVORA. The prisoners at Evora and Elvas subsist by charity. Some of them had been confined three, four, or five years, without being brought to trial.[2]

SPAIN

I entered Spain at Badajoz, 9 March, 1783. This country abounds with charitable institutions, and there are at present few or no beggars in it. Most of the prisons have courts for men, with fountains or running water in the centre, and corridors for shade. The same separation of the sexes which I observed in the Portuguese prisons, takes place here; and it is the custom likewise, as in Portugal, for the gaolers to demand fees of prisoners before they are discharged. A condemned criminal, after the judges have made their report, is seldom pardoned by the king. After condemnation, he is called from the other prisoners into the chapel, where his sentence is read to him by a secretary, and a friar attends to exhort and comfort him, who never leaves him till he is executed. The sentence is generally read on Saturday, and the execution ordered for the Monday following.

When a confession is extorted from a criminal by torture, it is read to him twenty-four hours afterwards, that he may either confirm or retract it. But in some of the provinces this shocking practice does not take place.

[1] In this country the prisoners have a dispensation to eat meat the two first days of Lent (viz. Ash Wednesday and Thursday) so that families may send in to them the remains of their flesh provisions.

[2] At Elvas the Marshal de Valleré did me the favour to show me the new barracks, etc. I could not but remark to him, that I was persuaded, the closeness of them, as well as those under the ramparts, gave his soldiers their pale and languid look. He walked with me to a new fountain, and showed me the plan and intended inscription in honour of the chief magistrate, for whom I told the Marshal, I should have had a higher esteem, had I not found poor wretches in the prison, who never had been put on their examination or trial, for three or four years.

It is the custom at Madrid for two of the Privy Council to visit the prisons; and they often either reverse or alter the sentences of the inferior judges. When I was there, the sentence of one condemned to the Prado prison for eight years, was altered to four months; another sentenced to the same prison for six months, on account of his large family was discharged.

Some of the churches in Spain are asylums for debtors and criminals. At Madrid there are only two, S. Sebastian for men, and S. Luis for women. At the former, there were five persons; one of whom said he had been there two years. At the latter, there was only one. A pavement round these churches, about three feet wide, is the verge of the privilege.[1]

SAN FERNANDO. San Fernando, about eight miles from the city, is a house of correction for petty offenders, vagrants, and beggars. Here were three hundred and nine men and five hundred and forty-seven women. Some were carrying stone to a lime-kiln; some making and washing the linen of the house; and some were spinning linen and worsted. The work-rooms are thirty-two feet wide; the infirmaries are spacious, at the top of the house. The prisoners were clothed in a uniform, and each is allowed two pairs of shoes and stockings. The men's apartments were clean, but the women's (as is generally the case in the Spanish prisons and hospitals) were much cleaner. Every one had a bed, a mattress and two coverlets. The women here have a court as well as the men; and both courts are commanded by the keeper's balcony. The provisions were good: the bread allowance is twenty ounces a day. Two of the prisoners attend at dinner, to see that each is served with his full portion of soup (three quarters of a pint). They are allowed three feasts in a year, Christmas, Easter, and San Fernando's day. Here is a shop for the sale of wine, the quality and price of which are fixed by the magistrates; but no spirituous liquors are permitted to be sold. No fees are paid at entrance, or discharge. The prison is attended by a physician,

[1] Dr. Moore, in his *View of Society and Manners in Italy*, judiciously observes, that, "the asylum which churches and convents offer to criminals, operates against the peace of society, and tends to the encouragement of this shocking custom (stabbing) in two different manners: first, it increases the criminal's hopes of escaping; secondly, it diminishes, in vulgar minds, the idea of the atrocity of the crime. When the populace see a murderer lodged within the sacred walls of a church, protected and fed by men who are revered on account of their profession, and the supposed sanctity of their lives; must not this weaken the horror which mankind naturally have for such a crime, and which it ought to be the aim of every government to augment?"—LETTER XLIII.